Copy

Japan & China

4

Sir T. Wade's No 176
of 10 Aug: 1874.

No 177

Peking
10th August 1874

My Lord.

In my despatch No 176 of this date I said that I should shew in the following despatch that the Chinese were certain to say in correspondence about the Japanese affair, what they ought not. Circumstances induced me to postpone completion of the report I contemplated. and

The Earl of Derby
&c &c

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and I have now the honor to refer Your Lordship to my Despatch No 186 of the 3rd Septr.

I have the honor to be,

My Lord,

With the highest respect

Your Lordship's

most obedient humble

Servant

Thomas Francis Wade.

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1874

Peking, 10th August.
Mr. Wade
No 177.
Rec^d Nov 17
Japan & China.
Completion of report
postponed to 3 Sept.

No 178

Peking
13 August 1874

My Lord

This afternoon I received a Telegram from Sir Harry Parkes, dated 7 instant, ~~of~~ announcing the appointment of a High Commissioner, Okubo by name, who would probably proceed to Peking the following day. The Commissioner, it was added, is not an Ambassador.

By the same courier I

received

The Right Honorable
The Earl of Derby
&c &c &c

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received a Despatch from Sir Harry Parkes dated 30th July, in which, upon the authority of the Japanese Foreign Minister, it is stated that Yanagiwara, the Minister now in Peking, had been instructed to express to the Tsungli Yamên at Peking the willingness of Japan to withdraw from Formosa, provided the Chinese Government undertook to keep the savages of the South of the Island in order by occupying the position now held by the Japanese troops, and provided also that the Chinese Government would justify the past proceedings of

Japan

Japan by admitting the right of the latter to take the steps she has adopted in this matter. If Japan obtained this admission, she was prepared to bring away her force from Formosa immediately, and no indemnity would be demanded.

I sent translation of the Telegram to the Prince of Kung and I mentioned at the same time the receipt of the Despatch above referred to, as containing interesting matter regarding which I should be glad to see some of the Ministers tomorrow.

I then went to call

upon

upon the Minister Yanagiwara. He had heard nothing from Japan regarding the appointment of a High Commissioner. His Interpreter at my request read him the paragraph in Sir Harry Parkes' Despatch already quoted, and I asked if anything had passed between him and the Tsung-li Yamên to the same effect.

After requesting explanation of the passage in which it was said that Chinese troops would occupy the positions now held by Japan,

the Minister Yanagiwara replied that his instructions were not precisely in the form shewn in the Despatch. The orders of his Sovereign were that the Japanese force should *not* be hastily withdrawn from Formosa.

I then asked the Minister if he saw his way to a speedy settlement of the question pending between the Governments of China and Japan.

I cannot be quite sure what his first reply was to this question, but I followed it up by observing that my reason for

for asking it was simply that at this moment Japanese troops were occupying country which the Chinese declared to be Chinese territory, while the Japanese on the other hand declared it not to be so; and that this constituted to say the least a point of *disagreement* between the two Governments.

The Japanese Minister replied that there was no doubt this disagreement, but that Japan's intentions were amicable, and that his instructions were to maintain

pacific

pacific relations with China

I begged him not to assume that I was offering an opinion on the merits of the case as between the Chinese Government and his own. I was merely seeking information for the benefit of my own Government, which would naturally be anxious when rumor of a possible misunderstanding should reach it, and which would have cast upon its Navy out here a considerable increase of trouble in the task of protecting British interests.

The Minister repeated

that

that Japan meant no harm to China, but that she could not submit to wrong or insult at the hands of China, and that if China were to subject her to either, —"to fly hastily to war"—, Japan was able and ready to fight.

As he had not noticed my deprecation of a belief that I wished to intrude my opinion upon him I repeated what I had said before.

Yanagiwara assured me that he perfectly understood this. He again repeated that he

did

did not see any way to a settlement near at hand, and added that discussion of the evacuation of Formosa had devolved upon the Japanese General Saigo, and the High Commissioner Shên Paochêng, named by the Chinese Government.

I do not affect to reproduce the Minister's words, but what I have written fairly represents what he said. It was said, I should observe, drily, but without anger or asperity.

I repeated that I only troubled the Minister with my questions for the information of

my

my Government, adding that I had been a long time in relations with the Ministers conducting foreign affairs in this country, and that if at any time I could be useful, I should be most happy.

Yanagiwara replied that he was aware of my long experience of this country, and its ways. I was also Doyen of the Corps Diplomatique. If, therefore, there were any matter on which he required information, he should not fail to come

to

to me.

All this was said very politely, but altogether with the air of a man who would rather dispense with the good offices tendered.

I then changed the subject, and after a little more talk on indifferent topics, I took my leave.

I learned in the course of the interview that the Ministers had been to return Yanagiwara's visit about an hour before I went to see him.

I have the honor to be,

My Lord,

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My Lord,
With the highest respect,
Your Lordship's most obedient
humble servant
Thomas Francis Wade.

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1874
Peking 13 August
Mr. Wade's
No. 178.

Recd. Nov 17

Formosa. Japanese
Minister's instructions

✓ The Queen ○
✓ Mr Disraeli
Circulate

✓
Approve having tendered
good offices
549 Novr D

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~~148~~

No. 179

Peking
19th August 1874

My Lord,

In explanation of my Telegram of this date Your Lordship will have learned from my earlier Despatch that there is to all appearance as great a chance of war as of peace between China and Japan, if indeed war be not the more likely of the two. This is one

reason

No. 178

The Earl of Derby
&c &c &c